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for every child

UNICEF Innocenti – Global Office of Research and Foresight

Annual Report 2024



2024 Snapshot

- In 2024, UNICEF Innocenti published 134 research and evidence products, including eight major titles.

- Our publications were cited in 418 policy documents by 96 policy organizations across 27 countries in 16 languages, including citations from 76 governments, 67 think tanks and 11 legislative bodies.[1]

- *State of the World's Children 2024: The future of childhood in a changing world* achieved substantial global and national media coverage. Launch events were held in Nicaragua, Zimbabwe, India, Sweden, Brussels and Dubai.

- Gender Responsive Age Sensitive Research Programme (GRASSP), a five-year research programme on social protection and gender equality produced 60 publications and 29 communication outputs, influencing policy decisions in Angola, Ethiopia and Viet Nam, and generating 76 citations in policy documents, including the World Bank's Gender Strategy.

- The Transfer Project published six journal articles and completed data collection in Ghana and Zambia. This project led to policy changes (e.g., increased cash transfers in Ghana and Tunisia), and improved enrolment of pregnant and lactating women in Ethiopia's social protection programme. The findings also contributed to the institutionalization of child benefits in Tunisia.

- Education research influenced teacher support programmes in Angola, the Republic of the Congo and Senegal and informed Cambodia's National Action Plan for Inclusive Education. It also improved digital learning implementation in Ghana, Guinea, Lebanon, Sudan and Uruguay, and secured policy dialogue and funding for programmes in Côte d'Ivoire, Mali, the United Republic of Tanzania and Zambia. The team also worked with local academics, ministry officials and UNICEF offices in Bangladesh, Botswana, Côte d'Ivoire, Ghana, Liberia, Rwanda and Sierra Leone to improve the use of evidence in large-scale education programmes. The *Improving Education in Africa* report synthesized evidence from 33 countries and 167,000 schools, and was presented at 'The Continental Education Conference 2024: A Focus on Transforming African Education', hosted by the Africa Union in partnership with UNICEF. The *Making Digital Learning Work* report, based on six years of research from 12 countries, provided actionable insights on effective digital learning strategies to support teachers and enhance student outcomes in both humanitarian and development contexts.

1 Overton

- The '2024 Leading Minds Conference on Climate Action: Breaking the barriers and challenging the ctatus quo', co-created with young people, focused on six key areas: loss and damage; eco-literacy, climate education and green skilling; equity in energy transition; climate justice; climate finance; and governance. It resulted in a strong collection of solution-focused products.

- Publications in *The Lancet* and *Nature Medicine* and participation in global forums reinforced UNICEF Innocenti leadership in addressing violence against women and violence against children. The multi-year research project in South Asia on child labour and education offered insights on using schooling to combat child labour. Analysis of adolescent girls' time use was published as part of the G20 Brazil's Think Tank Initiative. The Strategic Technical Assistance for Research (STAR) Initiative continued supporting evidence generation to end child marriage and female genital mutilation (FGM), providing technical assistance to 19 country studies across 10 countries. UNICEF Innocenti also produced new research on migration policies along the Central Mediterranean route and studies on child migration and displacement in Afghanistan and Pakistan, and the Horn of Africa. Children's voices were included in the *2024 Annual Report of the UN Special Representative of the Secretary-General on Violence Against Children* to the Human Rights Council, strengthening global advocacy for children's rights and protection.

- The *Responsible Innovation in Technology for Children* (RITEC) report examined the potential of video games to contribute to children's well-being and produced a design toolbox to help designers integrate well-being into their game designs. The RITEC-8 framework is now used by major gaming companies.

- As part of the Disrupting Harm project, surveys were conducted with 9,000 children and 9,000 caregivers across nine countries to gather insights on online violence, sexual exploitation and abuse. The project included 60 in-depth interviews with young survivors and engaged with over 200 duty-bearers in national child protection systems, making it one of the largest studies on this issue.

- The *Neurotechnology and Children* report laid the foundation for a futures-driven policy guidance to be completed in 2025.

- UNICEF Innocenti developed a global research agenda for children with disabilities through consultations with over 200 stakeholders, including children and youth with lived experiences. Key reports published include a systematic review, *Arts and Culture for Inclusion*, an updated *Inclusion Matters* and *From Insight to Inclusion*, which details how UNICEF's research impacts children with disabilities.

- UNICEF Innocenti published an evidence synthesis report on what works to improve outcomes for children through cash transfers combined with Social and Behaviour Change (SBC) programming. The report was cited by Ugo Gentilini, Global Lead for Social Assistance at the World Bank, as one the most influential social protection papers of 2024.

- UNICEF Innocenti released *Implementation Research Case Compendium: A systematic presentation of the learnings from nine countries*. The case compendium is part of UNICEF Innocenti's contribution to the development of UNICEF's upcoming Implementation Research (IR) Roadmap and digital IR repository to be launched in 2025, supported by the Norwegian University of Science and Technology's Centre for Global Health Inequalities Research (financed by the Norwegian Research Council).

- UNICEF Innocenti organized and facilitated two sessions and one advanced session on UNICEF's applied behavioral science research at the 2024 United Nations Behavioral Science week.

- First phase of child participatory research on well-being and futures was completed with disadvantaged children in Ghana and Italy.

- Strategic foresight has been integrated into UNICEF Innocenti's work, informing organizational planning and programming, and into a guide to developing a situation analysis (SiTAn) and Country Programme Document (CPD) guidelines. UNICEF offices including the Latin America and the Caribbean and East Asia and the Pacific Regional Offices and the Supply Division have begun implementing foresight analyses.

- *Prospects for Children in 2024: A Global Outlook* was adopted by regional offices for advocacy and planning (e.g., tailored analysis for for the Regional Offices for South Asia, Eastern and Southern Africa, Latin America and the Caribbean and the Middle East and North Africa), as well as the UNICEF Division of Global Communication and Advocacy. The team's intelligence gathering continues to provide valuable insights to the Office of the Executive Director and senior leadership on geopolitical, societal and macroeconomic trends.

- Publication of *Loss and Damage Finance for Children* helped position UNICEF and children within the global dialogue and was used in advocacy efforts with the Board of the Fund for Responding to Loss and Damage and the transitional committee. Analysis on armed conflict and modern warfare informed Security Council briefings and contributed to engagement with the Group of Friends on Children and Armed Conflict. *Children's Involvement in Organized Violence* identified emerging trends on this topic and approaches to prevention and response. Papers on voting age and protest movements positioned UNICEF at the forefront of emerging youth activism trends.

- UNICEF Innocenti organized the 'Information and Decision Support Center Youth Foresight Workshop' in Egypt in partnership with the Prime Minister's Think Tank, engaging 30 young leaders to explore the futures of learning and shape future education policies. The United Nation General Assembly 'Summit of the Future' featured the first youth foresight session, which was facilitated with the UN Futures Lab and the UN Youth Office. It was attended by 150 participants.

- Youth-led foresight and research publications included: the *Emerging Horizons* paper, which was on climate futures; the *Intergenerational Perspectives on the Futures of Governance* report, which highlighted challenges to, and future pathways for, democracy; the *Meaningful Youth Engagement in the Multilateral System* report, which was informed by over 80 youth delegates and identified barriers and solutions for impactful youth participation; and the *Young Visionaries: Child rights youth foresight report 2024* which shared insights from 12 Fellows' research involving 800 children and youth in 50 workshops across 12 countries.

- In 2024, the office published a *What Works* series – short web articles that highlighed evidence-based insights and expert recommendations for key UNICEF programme areas. The series included:
  - 'What works to advance pre-primary education?'
  - 'What works to eliminate child labour?'
  - 'What works to enhance gender equality through social protection?'
  - 'What works to reduce violence against children and women in the home?'
  - 'What works to prevent child marriage?'

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Note from the Director

In 2024, we showed our commitment to upholding children's rights by delivering rigorous, influential and forward-looking research on challenges affecting children today and tomorrow.

We prioritized tracing the impacts of our research to better understand how it reaches decision makers and practitioners. We were delighted to learn that, across the globe, our research has led to new legislation, legal measures and instruments; capacity-building and training tools for industries, governments, policymakers, law enforcement and frontline workers; and guidance to schools, communities, parents and caregivers.

Feedback from our networks and partners showed how much people care about protecting and promoting children's rights; elevating the views of children and young people into public and private sector decision-making and policy; and using the powerful tools of evidence and foresight to inform and enhance policies and programmes.

We dedicated two of our major reports to the future. *Prospects for Children in 2025: Building resilient systems for children's futures* argued that, confronted with the interconnected crises of climate change, conflict and economic instability, countries must bolster their national systems to anticipate and prepare for what lies ahead. From disaster preparedness that safeguards schools and communities, to education systems that can adapt during emergencies, to inclusive health-care systems that respond to immediate needs while planning for future risks, action is urgently needed to secure children's rights and well-being.

The State of the World's Children: The future of childhood in a changing world asked, What will the world be like for children in 2050? The report revealed a world of the future in which children are concentrated in poorer and more urban places and exposed to more deadly climate risks. The report warned against a lack of investment in proven solutions such as social protection benefits, early learning and girls' education. Through the examination of three global trends, demographic shifts, the climate and environmental crises and frontier technologies, the report recommended ways for stakeholders to pave the way to a better future.

Today, the need for evidence-based decision making and strategic planning through foresight remains crucial – if not increasingly important – for public trust, effective policies and holding governments and organizations accountable. Continued declines in foreign aid demand

innovation and transparent and efficient use of available resources, together with evidence-based approaches to ensure impactful programmes. Similarly, robust strategies – which are flexible and resilient – depend on our ability to anticipate potential future challenges and disruptions and empower all of us to be proactive rather than reactive.

In 2024, our other top agenda items included renewed effort to make the case for investing in education, and providing a platform for young people to engage with other thought leaders and help us put ideas into practice through our reports and convening events.

Thanks to the dedication and perseverance of each member of our team – and to the support and collaboration with donors and partners – we successfully delivered on these goals and set a high bar for ourselves in 2025. I look forward to continuing our work together to defend and advance the rights of children, and to help create a better future for all.



Bo Viktor Nylund
Director

Overview

In 2024, UNICEF Innocenti's work on research and foresight has focused not only on understanding and responding to current issues affecting children and their families but also on anticipating future challenges and opportunities for children in an increasingly complex, interconnected world. Children, especially those in vulnerable settings, face persistent barriers to the realization of their rights, safety, survival, well-being and development. These challenges have been further exacerbated by global concerns such as climate change, conflict and rising geopolitical instability, which expose children to heightened risks, including internal displacement, irregular migration and violence.

Climate change, in particular, has become a major driver of vulnerability, with its far-reaching impacts worsening resource scarcity, increasing the intensity and frequency of natural disasters and pushing more families into poverty. Economic fragmentation continues to threaten families' livelihoods, children's growth and youth employment, while a fragmented multilateral system struggles to address key issues affecting children. This backdrop of escalating challenges calls for targeted, evidence-based research and foresight that can drive positive change, promote greater equity and inspire transformative action for children and their families.

The ongoing trends in social protection, particularly in response to poverty and inequality, have been central to shaping UNICEF Innocenti's research agenda. Countries are increasingly adopting innovative social protection measures, recognizing that traditional cash transfers alone do not fully address poverty's complexity. 'Cash Plus' schemes, which combine cash support with social services for vulnerable groups, are gaining momentum. UNICEF Innocenti's research evaluates the effectiveness, operational performance and cost-efficiency of these policy innovations, focusing on their impact on poverty reduction and child well-being. UNICEF Innocenti's research has also focused on quantifying the cost of inaction, highlighting the inevitable consequences of underinvesting in social protection systems, which could lead to deeper inequalities, higher future costs and missed opportunities for economic and human development.

In addition to its focus on child well-being, UNICEF Innocenti continues to play a key role in researching global child poverty. Despite progress, the pace of reduction remains too slow to meet the 2030 Sustainable Development Goal targets. UNICEF Innocenti's research examines the root causes and consequences of child poverty, including the impact of environmental shocks, offering new insights into children in impoverished contexts. This work extends to high-income countries, where child poverty persists despite national prosperity.

Another key focus has been advancing gender equality, reducing gender-based violence, and empowering women and girls. Gender inequality remains a significant challenge, particularly for girls, in both humanitarian and development settings. Through the GRASSP programme, UNICEF Innocenti has explored how gender dynamics influence social protection programmes, integrating gender components across research activities and identifying factors that enhance programme outcomes. A priority was understanding how to design effective interventions to help women and girls overcome sociocultural and economic barriers.

In education, UNICEF Innocenti has focused on identifying strategies to improve learning outcomes and reduce disparities. A major challenge is the shortage of teachers, with sub-Saharan Africa alone needing 15 million more by 2030. In 2024, UNICEF Innocenti's research explored large-scale digital learning programmes in humanitarian and development contexts, emphasizing teacher capacity building, pedagogical practices, and using data for actionable decisions. The need for education investment is especially urgent in Africa, where nearly a billion children and adolescents – 40 per cent of the global total – will reside by 2050. This demographic shift offers a chance for Africa to drive global growth, but only if education systems meet the needs of children and young people. Recognizing education's pivotal role, the African Union declared 2024 the Year of Education. In response, UNICEF Innocenti launched the *Improving Education in Africa* report, synthesizing evidence from 33 countries and data from 167,000 schools to guide decision-makers in strengthening education systems across the continent.

UNICEF Innocenti continued to focus on the growing impact of digital transformation on children's lives, particularly online risks like online sexual abuse. Research explored children's interactions with emerging technologies, including neurotechnology and artificial intelligence (AI), ensuring their voices shape digital policy. The RITEC project examined how video games can contribute to children's well-being, suggesting that, when designed thoughtfully, they can support positive development. The research also emphasized the importance of companies and states in upholding the best interests of the child in digital design and management.

In 2024, UNICEF Innocenti saw an expansion of its foresight function with preparations for the United Nations 'Summit of the Future' and efforts to understand global challenges through forward-looking research. The development of a UNICEF-wide Community of Practice for Foresight reflects the growing importance of futures thinking in shaping policies and programmes that will benefit children in the long term. UNICEF Innocenti's foresight activities have focused on emerging issues such as climate security, political instability and economic shifts, working to ensure that children's needs remain central to these discussions. UNICEF Innocenti has worked, including through youth consultations, to integrate the perspectives of children and young people in policymaking, ensuring that their voices shape the future of child rights and well-being.

Driving global discourse

The State of the World's Children 2024

Following on from the United Nations Summit of the Future, *The State of the World's Children* (SOWC 2024) marked the first future-focused edition in the report's 45-year history. Launched on World Children's Day (WCD), SOWC 2024 showcased projections for childhood in 2050, revealing both threats and opportunities for child rights.

The report examined three megatrends shaping children's future – population shifts, climate crises and frontier technologies. Analyzing three potential scenarios (business-as-usual, accelerated development, and delayed development), it projects impacts on child survival, climate exposure, education and urbanization. One stark finding was that, if the current path continues, eight times more children are projected to face extreme heatwaves.

These insights enable countries, multilateral institutions and child advocates to anticipate the challenges and opportunities ahead so that they can craft impactful policies for a changing world. SOWC 2024 calls for climate action, preparation for population shifts and proper governance of frontier technologies, incorporating perspectives from Youth Foresight Fellows on creating a better future for children.

Marking the 35th Anniversary of the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child (CRC), SOWC 2024 supported events in 189 countries, with a launch event at the Dubai Future Forum bringing together UNICEF leadership and youth voices to discuss shaping children's future. Highlights from the 20 November 2024 launch include:

- **Media coverage:** SOWC 2024 garnered 677 media items worldwide, highlighting children's increased exposure to extreme heat waves and emphasizing that the future remains ours to shape.

- **Digital reach:** The report achieved 1.3 million views across all languages on unicef.org in the first 10 days, demonstrating strong interest in its findings.

- **Social media:** The campaign reached nearly 1 million decision makers on LinkedIn, with engagement rates 40 per cent higher than for the previous year.

SOWC 2024 successfully elevated global awareness of children's futures and mobilized key stakeholders to take concrete actions in support of child rights and their meaningful participation in decision-making processes.

Research at a glance

Social and economic policy

Gender Responsive Age Sensitive Social Protection

The five-year GRASSP programme was completed in 2024. GRASSP examined the integration of gender considerations into social protection systems and examined the ways in which social protection contributes to gender equality. The programme resulted in 60 comprehensive research publications and generated 29 additional communication outputs. These products included seven blogs, four podcasts, four web articles, four web videos, eleven think pieces and various social media posts to promote broad dissemination, reach and use of the research. The GRASSP synthesis report was launched in July 2024 at an event attended by over 300 participants from UNICEF and multiple development partners. GRASSP-generated evidence continues to influence policy, with 76 citations in policy documents. Key examples of policy impact include:

- **Angola:** The government noted that GRASSP research had influenced their decision to continue 'Valor Criança', the country's first social cash transfer programme targeting households with children aged 0-5 in municipalities prone to food insecurity.

- **Ethiopia:** GRASSP evidence contributed to ongoing discussions on the design of Productive Safety Net Program (PSNP) 6, the government's flagship social protection programme. Follow-up meetings with the World Bank, the United Kingdom's Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office, and Irish Aid confirmed that GRASSP research is being used to shape PSNP 6.

- **Viet Nam:** GRASSP findings informed the review of 'Decree 20', the government's social protection policy, which is currently being redrafted.

- **Influence on Development Partners:** GRASSP research outputs are being used to inform the World Bank's Gender Strategy.

Transfer Project

The Transfer Project is a research and learning initiative led by UNICEF including UNICEF Innocenti and UNICEF Regional and Country Offices in partnership with the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) and the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill and funded since 2024 by the Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency (Sida). The Transfer Project has generated rigorous evidence on the impacts of government-run cash transfer programmes in development and humanitarian settings, mainly in sub-Saharan Africa. Key achievements of the

Transfer Project this year include the publication of six journal articles and the completion of primary data collection in Ghana and Zambia. The evidence generated has contributed to policy changes in several countries:

- **Ethiopia:** Findings from the evaluation highlighted challenges with transitioning pregnant and lactating women from the public works programme to Temporary Direct Support (TDS). In response, the programme clarified the roles of frontline workers in identifying and reporting eligible women, ensuring automatic enrolment in TDS and improving enrolment.

- **Ghana:** In Ghana evidence influenced two significant policy decisions. First, the government doubled the cash transfer amount for the Livelihood Empowerment Against Poverty (LEAP) programme after analyses showed the real value of the transfer had steadily declined between 2015 and 2023. Impact evaluations in 2017 and 2022 revealed low effects on indicators such as schooling. Second, the government adopted the LEAP-Integrated Social Services (LEAP-ISS) initiative, a multi-social-sector integrated cash-plus programme, in response to Transfer Project evaluations showing limited cash programme effects on the use of social services.

- **Tunisia:** Evidence from four studies conducted under the Child-Sensitive Social Protection research programme contributed to key policy decisions. The first was the institutionalization of the Back-to-School national cash programme as part of the state budget. Second, inclusion of a cash allowance for children aged 6–18 in the 2025 finance law, approved by the Tunisian Parliament, to be funded through the state budget starting in 2025.

Child poverty

Innocenti Report Card 18: Child poverty in the midst of wealth, published in December 2023, continues to make a significant impact. It has led to invitations to speak at three major European policy events. Additionally, the findings have influenced government actions, including informing the United Kingdom's task force on child poverty.

Additionally, three research projects on the 'new poor' in Georgia, India and Uganda highlighted the changing profiles of children living in poverty, and assessed broader policy implications.

Child well-being

Jointly published with the UNICEF European Union (EU) Office, *The State of Children in the European Union* report summarized and analyzed child well-being and progress for children in the European Union (EU) from 2019 to 2024. It also identified key issues to address in the upcoming political cycle. The report was accompanied by four policy briefs focusing respectively on child poverty, mental health, environment and digital technologies.

Education

Education research focuses on six key areas aimed at building resilient education systems and identifying scalable solutions to improve educational outcomes. These research programmes, Implementation Research Improving Education (IRIE), Data Must Speak (DMS), Digital Learning, Learning is for Everyone (LiFE), Teachers for All (T4A), and Women in Learning Leadership (WiLL), focus on different aspects of educational challenges and opportunities.

- **IRIE** focuses on embedding research into education programmes aimed at improving children's learning – this includes accelerated education programmes, remedial education programmes and more.

- **DMS** focuses on identifying high-performing schools and effective practices across 15 countries to enhance children's education. Its findings emphasize that schools with equitable resource allocation, strong leadership, targeted teaching strategies and active community and parent involvement tend to achieve better student performance.

- **Digital Learning** explores ways to reach marginalized children through digital tools like the Learning Passport, Akelius Digital Learning Initiative and Accessible Digital Textbooks. It highlights the importance of proper classroom technology, effective Information and Communications Technology (ICT) management and strong teacher support, noting that successful digital education solutions require scalable, sustainable partnerships and ongoing learning.

- **LiFE** investigates disability inclusion in education across seven countries, uncovering barriers such as policies favouring segregated schooling, inadequate teacher preparation for inclusive education and a lack of accessible materials. It also points to bullying in mainstream schools as a significant obstacle.

- **T4A** examines teacher deployment in 13 African countries, revealing that imbalances in teacher distribution exacerbate educational inequalities. Centralized teacher allocation systems often fail to align teacher supply with school needs, while rural areas suffer from inadequate incentives and facilities, further hindering teacher retention.

- **WiLL**, a joint initiative with UNESCO-International Institute for Education Planning (IIEP), addresses the underrepresentation of women in school leadership across seven countries. Research shows that increasing women's representation in leadership roles can improve learning outcomes and promote gender equality. However, women face significant cultural, structural and systemic barriers to leadership positions, requiring targeted policy interventions to overcome these challenges.

Collectively, these research initiatives provide valuable insights into the factors that can improve learning outcomes: equitable resource allocation, effective leadership, inclusive education practices, balanced teacher deployment and gender-responsive leadership. Each programme contributes to a broader understanding of how to create a more effective and inclusive education system for all children. These education research findings have had significant reach and impact across various countries, contributing to education system improvements and policy development. Notably:

- In 15 countries, the research identified locally led solutions to enhance learning, prompting policy dialogues and securing additional funding for education system strengthening in Côte d'Ivoire, Ghana, Mali, Nepal, the United Republic of Tanzania and Zambia. In Ghana and Guinea, the research informed updates on the design and expansion of digital learning programs, including content delivery, technology use and operational considerations.

- In Cambodia, the research played a key role in shaping the National Action Plan for Inclusive Education 2024–2028, launched in June 2024. Meanwhile, in Djibouti and Mozambique, the findings were used to co-create policy recommendations and plans aimed at fostering more inclusive education systems.

- Additionally, Ministries of Education and UNICEF Country Offices have used the T4A research findings to advocate for critical issues, secure funding and design teacher support programmes. In Angola, the research contributed to the development of the 2024 National Education Compact Partnership on Teacher Empowerment. In the Republic of Congo and Senegal, Ministries of Education will use the findings to map teacher conditions in hard-to-staff areas and advocate for resources, quotas and greater involvement in decision-making.

Gender rights and protection

Birth registration, child labour

New research was initiated on the resilience of birth registration systems amid climate change and the costs of not innovating civil registration and vital statistics systems (CRVS), despite strong evidence of their significant social and economic benefits. Two large-scale, multi-year and multi-country research projects were concluded on the intersections between child labour and education in South Asia and gender-responsive age-sensitive social protection. A particular focus emerged on adolescent girls' time spent on unpaid domestic work in India and globally, resulting in a co-authored policy brief prepared for T20 Brasil, an engagement group linked to the G20, which was hosted by Brazil 2024.

Prevention of violence against children and violence against women

In 2024, UNICEF Innocenti published five evidence briefs and finalized a multi-country study to support the operationalization of UNICEF's Child Protection Strategy 2021-2030, including increasing the organization's understanding and focus on the gender dimensions of violence against children. With partners, the World Health Organization (WHO) and the Sexual Violence Research Initiative (SVRI), UNICEF Innocenti launched a global research agenda for the intersections of violence against children and violence against women to guide future evidence generation. The recognition of UNICEF Innocenti's intellectual influence is also reflected in our recent scientific publications in *The Lancet* and *Nature Medicine*, and in our involvement in shaping and implementing two key global conferences – the Sexual Violence Research Initiative (SVRI) Forum 2024 and the First Global Ministerial Conference on Ending Violence against Children – where UNICEF Innocenti organized several sessions and advocated for evidence-based decision-making. UNICEF Innocenti also played a key role in the Wilton Park meeting 'Building Resilient Societies: The impact of adversity, violence or traumatic experiences on adolescent brain, mental health and psychosocial development', which included producing the conference report. At the International Society for the Prevention of Child Abuse and Neglect (ISPCAN) Congress in Sweden, we organized a symposium exploring access to justice for children and women exposed to violence in the home. UNICEF Innocenti established partnerships with key stakeholders including United Nations agencies (e.g., WHO, UN Women and UNFPA), multilaterals (e.g., the World Bank), academic institutions (e.g., the London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine, the University of Cape Town and Oxford University), research networks (e.g., SVRI) and civil society organizations (e.g., Equimundo, Prevention Collaborative and ISPCAN). Looking ahead, UNICEF Innocenti will advance understanding of children's and women's experiences of violence both online and offline. UNICEF Innocenti will also generate evidence through partnerships with the World Bank, WHO and SVRI to promote access to justice for those exposed to violence. Finally, evidence-based guidance will continue to be produced to support the implementation of UNICEF's child protection and gender mandates.

Child migration and displacement

A comparative analysis was completed on forcibly displaced Afghan children and internally displaced Pakistani children (IDPs), drawing on the voices and perspectives of child and youth directly affected by migration, displacement and return. The voices of children collected through this and previous research in Afghanistan and the Horn of Africa were drawn on as illustrative elements in the *Annual Report of the Special Representative of the Secretary-General on Violence against Children* and also produced as a standalone paper highlighting the experiences of children on the move in diverse settings. Additional working papers in 2024 focused on refugee children's access to preventative healthcare, the impact of migration on gender identity, and a background summary of key migration and displacement trends for children in Latin America and the Caribbean. UNICEF Innocenti also co-developed a new frontier data methodology for estimating numbers of children separated from their families in contexts of internal displacement.

A new research Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the University of Virginia's Humanitarian Collaborative, along with ongoing collaborations with the European University Institute's Migration Policy Centre and the University of Notre Dame's School of Law, collectively expand UNICEF Innocenti's work on child migration and displacement. UNICEF Innocenti also continued its co-leadership of the Assessment, Measurement, and Evidence Working Group within the Alliance for Child Protection in Humanitarian Action (ACPHA).

Harmful practices

Through the STAR initiative, UNICEF Innocenti supports change for girls by generating research and evidence on "what works and how" to end harmful practices like child marriage and FGM. Key publications include a synthesis report on effective strategies to prevent child marriage, launched on the International Day of the Girl, and country-specific briefs on evidence-based solutions to end FGM and child marriage. A multi-country study on implementing child marriage programmes in humanitarian settings – covering Iraq, Jordan, Lebanon, the Syrian Arab Republic and Yemen – was completed, along with a validation workshop with stakeholders. A similar study has been initiated in the Eastern and Central Africa (ECA) and West and Central Africa (WCA) regions.

Digital engagement and protection

Digital technology, play and child well-being

The RITEC report explored the question, Can video games contribute to the well-being of children? If the answer is 'Yes', then, 'How'? This research looked at the voices of the young, based on the scientific study of children in six countries. It concluded that digital games can indeed contribute to the well-being of children if designed in a way that supports their needs and positive development. Based on the research findings, a design toolbox was launched that provided designers with practical tools for incorporating support for children's well-being into their design process. It provided an overview of how to design for children's well-being in digital play, and it included a list of relevant game design features to incorporate.

The RITEC-8 framework for digital game design and its toolbox is currently being used by major gaming companies in their development process and has led to the creation of an industry-design fellowship hosted by the Joan Ganz Cooney Centre at Sesame Workshop, which teaches industry designers how to apply these evidence-informed tools in their work.

Online sexual abuse

UNICEF Innocenti continued its research on online sexual abuse implemented in 12 new countries, including surveys with 9,000 children and 9,000 caregivers as part of the Disrupting Harm project (in collaboration with ECPAT and INTERPOL). The research also included 70 in-depth interviews with young survivors of online sexual abuse and conversations with over 200 duty-bearers in

national child protection systems about their experiences in handling such cases. This work makes significant contributions to understanding ethics and safeguarding when conducting research on sensitive topics with young people. Results will be published in 2025.

Advancing research on emerging technologies

New work on neurotechnology was initiated to advance understanding of this field and its impacts on children's rights. A scoping project on potential AI use cases in education was also launched to better inform UNICEF's actions in this emerging space. Research on the digital and AI skills children will need in the future has similarly been initiated. A related project was launched to explore how the principle of the best interests of the child, as outlined in the CRC, can be practically applied by Member States and companies in the design and governance of the digital environment.

Disability inclusion research

The Global Research Agenda for Children with Disabilities

The Global Research Agenda for Children with Disabilities was developed through extensive consultations and a disability research prioritization exercise engaging children with disabilities as young as age 5, youth, organizations of persons with disabilities, donors, foundations, researchers and practitioners. It outlines priority research areas and provides a strategic framework to close evidence gaps and drive investment in inclusive policies and programmes. At the Global Disability Summit 2025, a call to action will urge governments, donors and researchers to prioritize and fund disability-inclusive research.

From Insight to Inclusion: How UNICEF's research evidence impacts children with disabilities

This report demonstrates the tangible impact of UNICEF's disability-related research, showcasing how evidence has shaped policies, strengthened advocacy and improved programme design across multiple countries. Through compelling case studies, it illustrates how data-driven approaches have led to inclusive education reforms, better healthcare access and social protection improvements, making a strong case for continued investment in evidence-based disability inclusion.

Inclusion Matters: An updated global evidence and gap report

The 2024 update of the 2022 *Inclusion Matters* report presents the latest evidence on inclusive interventions for children with disabilities in low- and middle-income countries. It maps significant research progress over the past two years, noting increased studies in health, family and community life and awareness. However, it also reveals persistent gaps in inclusive education, protection and empowerment, calling for greater investment in under-researched areas.

Arts and Culture for Inclusion: A systematic review

This systematic review explores how arts and culture programmes promote social inclusion for children with disabilities. It examines diverse interventions, from music and dance to theatre and visual arts, identifying their impact on self-esteem, social skills, and participation.

Flex Yang Visiting Fellowship for researcher with disabilities

The Flex Yang Visiting Fellowship supports researchers with disabilities in advancing inclusive research and evidence generation. Hosted by UNICEF Innocenti, the fellowship offers emerging and established scholars opportunities to lead disability-focused research, contribute to global policy discussions and strengthen advocacy for children with disabilities. Fellows benefit from mentorship, collaboration and a platform to drive impactful change in disability research. In 2024, two fellows joined the programme from Pakistan (Ishtiaq Ahmed) – researching math pedagogy for sight-impaired learners and Ethiopia (Tamiru Jo) exploring inclusive sports and its impact on children with disabilities.

Behavioural science and implementation research

UNICEF Innocenti has made an important contribution to UNICEF's work on applied behavioural science research, and the use of implementation research and social and behaviour change evidence to improve children's lives. Behavioral science and implementation research initiatives in 2024 covered topics across several UNICEF goal areas, including social protection, education, child protection, nutrition and primary health and immunization. Some key results and publications in 2024 include:

- A What Works in SBC evidence synthesis report on what works to improve outcomes for children through cash transfers combined with SBC programming. The report was cited by Ugo Gentilini (Global Lead for Social Assistance, World Bank) as among the most influential social protection papers of 2024.

- A What Works in SBC evidence-to-policy brief on reducing violence against children and women, building on an evidence synthesis research report on what works to reduce violence against children and women in the home?

- The Implementation Research Case Compendium: A systematic presentation of the learnings from nine countries. The case compendium is part of UNICEF Innocenti's contribution to the development of UNICEF's upcoming Implementation Research Roadmap and digital IR repository to be launched in 2025.

- Research in Afghanistan, Nigeria and Pakistan on UNICEF's work with religious leaders as part of the Global Polio Eradication Initiative. Initial findings shared in webinars with Global Polio Eradication Initiative partners resulted in new funding for UNICEF Innocenti to undertake additional research related to the transition of polio assets (human, intellectual and financial) to strengthen routine immunization and primary healthcare systems in priority geographies.

- Implementation research in India and the United Republic of Tanzania on the use of human-centered design and behavioral science to increase uptake of immunization services among zero-dose communities in the Ilala district of Dar-Es-Salaam and low-coverage districts in Uttar Pradesh and Meghalaya.

- Organizing and facilitating two basic sessions and one advanced session at the 2024 United Nations Behavioral Science week.

Foresight and anticipatory policy

UNICEF Innocenti undertook forward-looking analysis through *Prospects for Children in 2024: A Global Outlook*, which outlined eight key trends most relevant for children in 2024. And UNICEF Innocenti produced and published comprehensive future scenarios analysis with the Pardee Institute for International Futures, assessing child well-being in the twenty-first century.

The *Youth, Protests and Polycrisis* analysis gained notable traction, being featured on platforms like Oxfam's 'From Poverty to Power' blog, *Global Policy Journal* and the United Nations Peace and Security website. Its impact extended to Latin America, leading to Spanish translations and fostering collaborations with academic institutions like the University of York and civil society organizations including CIVICUS. UNICEF Innocenti received excellent feedback on a *Should Children Vote?* explainer, which was the most visited page on the UNICEF Innocenti website and is the top Google search result for "should children vote?"

In climate work, the team advocated for child-sensitive considerations in loss and damage finance through the publication *Loss and Damage Finance for Children*. This work contributed to elevating organizational advocacy efforts on the global stage and influenced the development of the fund for responding to climate-induced loss and damage. The report was cited in key UNICEF publications, including the COP29 Policy Briefing.

The team pioneered new workstreams on emerging topics through two high-level expert advisory panels – one on 'Fintech and Children' (with the support of the Finnish Government) and another on 'Taxation and Children', in collaboration with UNICEF Headquarters Social Policy Division. The team also initiated innovative collaboration with Office of Emergency Programmes (EMOPS) to develop an integrated approach to data-gathering across humanitarian and development contexts using foresight methodologies.

On green school-to-work transitions, the team developed a holistic framework for understanding green transitions. This framework was disseminated at key forums, including the Least Developed Countries Forum and the Asia Pacific Youth Symposium, and its findings were incorporated into the British Council's toolkit for greening Technical and Vocational Education and Training.

In partnership with Africa Union Development Agency – New Partnership for Africa's Development (AUDA-NEPAD) and the Pardee Center, UNICEF Innocenti's work on the African Continental Free Trade Agreement (AfCFTA) helped integrate children's perspectives into trade policy discourse. This collaboration resulted in the inclusion of trade work in the MoU between UNICEF and AUDA-NEPAD and its mention in AUDA-NEPAD's submission to the African Union Assembly. The official launch is planned for 2025.

Ethics in evidence

Significant progress has also been made in advancing ethical standards in evidence activities. A draft *Policy on Ethics in Evidence Activities* and an accompanying *Procedure on Ethical Review for Evidence Activities* were developed to replace the 2021 guidelines. These updates introduce a principles-based approach that spans the entire lifecycle of evidence activities. The revised policy simplifies language, enhances accessibility, and improves alignment with related regulations.

In June 2024, UNICEF Innocenti hosted a public webinar on 'Researching Sensitive Topics Involving Children', featuring global experts who shared insights on managing risk, distress and trauma in research design and data collection. The outcome paper will be published in 2025.

Resources to support ethical practice were expanded and some of the key additions included a case studies page, which offers real-life examples demonstrating ethical principles in practice, and a recorded skill-share session on sensitive topics, developed in collaboration with the Disrupting Harm team. These materials have become valuable tools for building capacity and promoting good practice across UNICEF. A major publication milestone was a co-authored article in *Nature Medicine on Putting Children's Safety at the Heart of Violence Research*.

Collaboration with external partners remained a priority. UNICEF Innocenti engaged with the UN Bioethics Committee, United Nations Evaluation Group's Ethics Working Group (co-chair), and participated in high-level meetings such as the UNESCO Global Meeting on Ethics in AI, the UNESCO and WHO Global Meeting of National Ethics Committees, and discussions with the Biometrics Institute. These collaborations ensured UNICEF's voice remained central in global conversations on ethics, particularly in emerging areas like AI and biometrics.

Youth empowerment and participation

In 2024, UNICEF Innocenti modelled meaningful youth engagement in research, foresight and convening through a series of initiatives and programmes elevating young people's voices and advocacy across various global platforms to support their influence in strategy, policy and decision-making. At Partner Days 2024, Fellows Joshua Opey (Ghana), Zainab Waheed (Pakistan), and Ijun Kim (the Republic of Korea) participated in and moderated panels on youth participation, child rights and youth foresight. Nahjae Nunes (United States of America) introduced youth foresight in the Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC) Youth Forum's official programme and moderated a panel that featured key figures like Assistant Secretary-General for Youth Affairs, Felipe Paullier, and Under Secretary-General for Policy, Guy Ryder. Additionally, a cohort of 12 young climate leaders from Albania, Bangladesh, Brazil, Colombia, Ghana, Iceland, Kenya, the Philippines, Uganda, the United Arab Emirates and the United States, shaped the agenda of the Leading Minds Conference on Climate and contributed key reports, including *Twelve Thought Pieces on Climate Activism*, *Collapse, Compromise, or Collective Action* and *Emerging Horizons* and the Leading Minds Conference outcomes report. The Information and Decision Support Center Youth Foresight Workshop in Egypt focused on the futures of learning, facilitated by UNICEF Innocenti's team and local youth leaders, and the Summit of the Future at United Nations General Assembly saw Youth Foresight Fellows facilitating the first youth foresight session, which drew 150 participants in the Trusteeship Council Chamber. Other key moments included the Futures of Democracy virtual workshop, co-led by Senior Fellows and attended by 50 youth, and the 2050 Future Child Exhibit at the Dubai Future Forum, where UNICEF Innocenti launched *The State of the World's Children* report and interactive child personas of 2050 were presented.

A series of reports also emerged from these activities, highlighting youth-driven research and foresight. The *Emerging Horizons* report captured insights from a youth-led foresight workshop on climate, while the *Intergenerational Perspectives on the Futures of Governance* report examined the challenges and future pathways for democracy. The *Meaningful Youth Engagement in the*

Multilateral System report, involving over 80 youth delegates, identified barriers and enablers for impactful youth engagement in multilateral fora. The *Young Visionaries: Child rights youth foresight report 2024*, produced in collaboration with UNICEF Country Offices, reached over 800 children and youth in more than 50 workshops across 12 countries.

Youth Foresight Fellows contributed to the *Prospects for Children in 2024: A Global Outlook*, authoring a 'Futures of Democracy' chapter and writing on emerging trends for the 2025 edition of the report. The Girls' Pact for the Future helped elevate adolescent girls' voices ahead of the United Nations Summit of the Future 2024. UNICEF Innocenti also supported key foresight workshops including UNICEF East Asia and Pacific Regional Office's Adolescent Girls strategy and a foresight initiative with Thailand's Children and Youth Council on youth challenges and opportunities. At the United Nations University – World Institute for Development Economics Research conference in Maputo, Fellows Aicha Robei (Algeria) and Fisayo Oyewale (Nigeria) contributed to discussions on development research in Africa. And youth voices were also amplified through the Democracy Podcast, where Fellows shared insights on the futures of democracy and civic space.

Convening

The establishment of a convening hub at UNICEF Innocenti has created a platform for collaboration and knowledge exchange among researchers, policymakers and practitioners focused on children's rights and well-being. By hosting events, providing space and offering logistical and administrative support for discussions and workshops, UNICEF Innocenti has facilitated the sharing of ideas and best practices. In 2024, the convening hub facilitated 36 events, including eight internal meetings organized for UNICEF Innocenti staff, 15 external convenings organized by other UNICEF offices and partners, and 13 convenings organized by UNICEF Innocenti teams involving other offices and partners. These gatherings have not only fostered cross-sector collaboration but have also contributed to global discourse on children's issues.

In summary, convening serves multiple strategic purposes for UNICEF Innocenti. It fosters dialogue on next-generation issues, facilitates ideas exchange, and promotes collaborative solutions to emerging challenges. Convening helps identify and engage thought leaders who shape global discourse and amplifying evidence-based insights. It serves as tool for translating evidence into impact – informing policies, fostering dialogue and strengthening thought leadership. By bringing diverse voices together, UNICEF Innocenti ensures its work remains relevant, impactful and at the forefront of global policy and practice.

Finance and partnerships

UNICEF Innocenti spent US$11 million in 2024 to deliver results through research and foresight. Of this amount, 78 per cent was mobilized from external partners, with the remainder funded by UNICEF. In the same year, UNICEF Innocenti raised US$12.5 million in additional programmable grant funding, either independently or in collaboration with UNICEF National Committees and the UNICEF Programme Group. The office also received over US$0.5 million from other UNICEF offices to support its joint research and foresight initiatives.

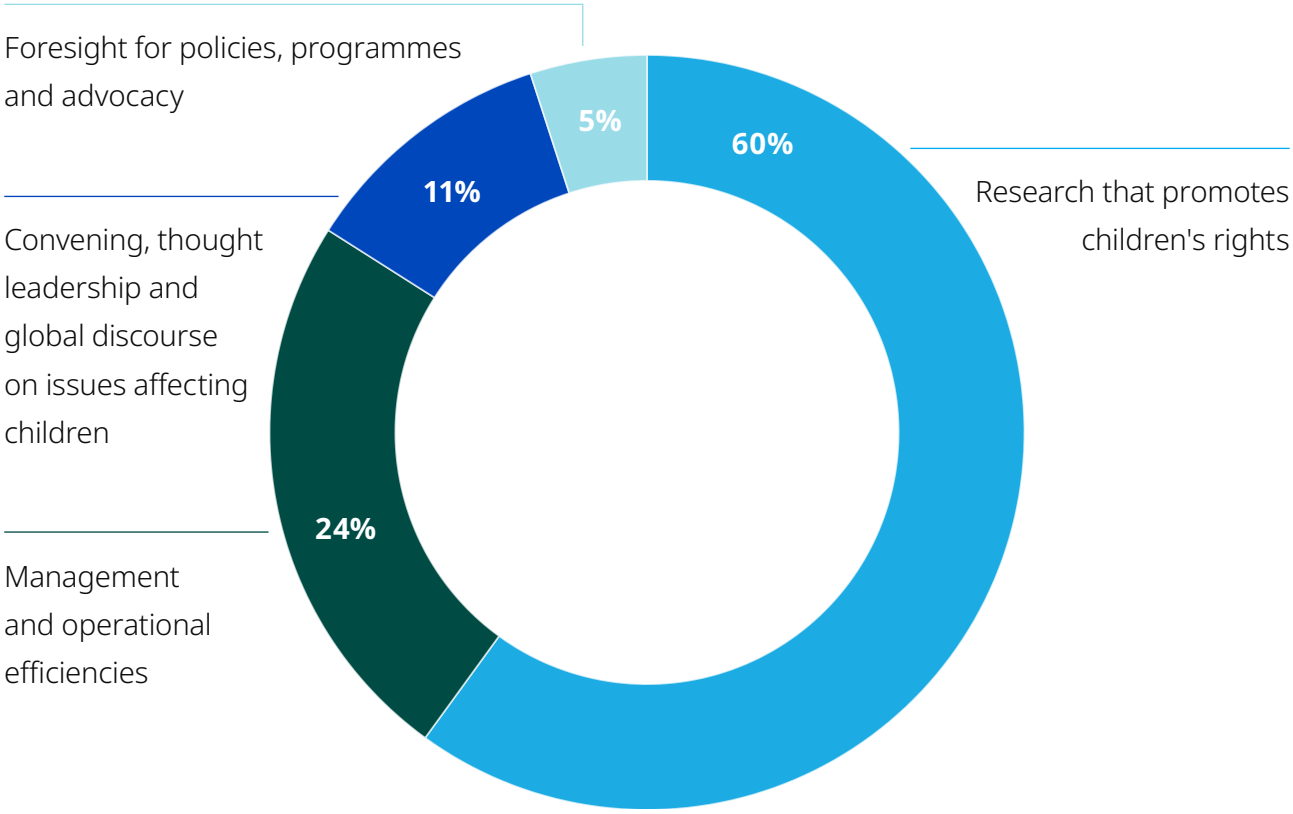
In terms of expenditures, the regular contribution from the Government of Italy was the most significant, followed by UNICEF core resources and complemented by other public and philanthropic funding sources from long-term partners (*see Figure 1*).

Figure 1: Top funding sources by expenditure in 2024

No.	Partner	Project names	Amount (US$)
1	Government of Italy	Regular contribution	2,487,987
2	UNICEF core funding	Institutional budget and regular resources	2,364,395
3	Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office, United Kingdom	Gender-Responsive and Age-Sensitive Social Protection; Evidence on Educational Strategies to Address Child Labour in South Asia; and Bridging the Gap from Evidence to Action through Improved Coordination and Capacity Building in Implementation Science for Education	1,377,095
4	Safe Online Initiative	Disrupting Harm 2: Investigating violence against children online	807,938
5	Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency (Sida), Sweden	The Transfer Project: Phase 3	593,938
6	International Development Research Centre on behalf of the GPE Knowledge and Innovation Exchange	Scaling Innovation: Data Must Speak about positive deviance approaches and Women in Learning Leadership	584,198
7	Japan Committee for UNICEF (individual donors)	Global Research Agenda and Platform for Children with Disabilities and Early Childhood Education in Djibouti projects	452,286
8	Oak Foundation (with support from the Committee for UNICEF Switzerland and Liechtenstein)	Learning is For Everyone: Research to inform disability-inclusive education and Update of the Concept of Evolving Capacities of the Child projects	314,353
9	Jacobs Foundation (with support from the Committee for UNICEF Switzerland and Liechtenstein)	Data Must Speak about Positive Deviance Approaches to Learning and Identifying barriers to women school leadership projects	303,733
10	Government of Finland	Foresight and Anticipatory Policy for Children	271,233

In 2024, 76 per cent of UNICEF Innocenti's expenditure focused on research and foresight generation and convening and thought leadership (*see Figure 2*).

Figure 2: UNICEF Innocenti expenditure by category, 2024



Partnerships

UNICEF Innocenti's research and foresight mandate is supported through collaborations with a diverse range of global and regional partners (*see Annex 1 for list*). Among these, the Government of Italy stands out as a long-term and reliable partner, offering both flexible funding and institutional backing for over three decades. In 2024, Italy's support continued to play a pivotal role, strengthening key collaborations and producing significant outcomes. The ongoing financial commitment from Italy, combined with additional funding, facilitated the expansion of UNICEF's presence in Florence. This included the renewal of the agreement with Istituto degli Innocenti and continued collaboration with the Municipality of Florence. Further negotiations with the Government of Italy to establish a new Host Country Agreement, solidifying the institutional relationship between UNICEF Innocenti and Italy is in progress. UNICEF Innocenti organized a seminar for the G7 Youth Engagement Group in line with Italy's G7 Presidency, fostering youth participation in global policy discussions. In collaboration with the European University Institute, UNICEF Innocenti implemented the Junior Fellowship Programme, as well as engaged in the U-Lead project, which focuses on creating an inclusive model for unaccompanied migrant children in Florence.

In addition, 2024 saw the launch and expansion of several new research and foresight efforts with key partners, including:

- The first Shape the Future: UNICEF Innocenti Partner Days event held on 29–30 January 2024 in Florence, Italy.

- A strategic partnership with the FCDO as part of the What Works Hub for Global Education (WWHGE). The partnership aims to enhance coordination and engagement on education evidence, provide implementation science support to WWHGE countries leveraging UNICEF's relationships at the country level and synthesize cross-country education evidence.

- New partnership agreements with the International Development Research Centre (IDRC) as part of the Global Partnership for Education's Knowledge and Innovation Exchange for two projects: Data Must Speak to Strengthen Capacity and Advance Local Evidence Use and Women in Learning Leadership – Advancing Gender-Responsive Education using Evidence in collaboration with the UNESCO International Institute for Education Planning.

- Strengthened partnership with the Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency (Sida) that led to the approval of the fourth phase of the Transfer Project (2025–2027), focusing on supporting longitudinal mixed-methods studies of government-run cash based programmes in sub-Saharan Africa, generating evidence on public finance for sustainable social protection, responding to evidence gaps on social protection in the region and facilitating learning and exchange among policymakers, implementers, researchers and civil society.

- Implementation of research on online child sexual abuse in 12 countries as part of the Disrupting Harm Project with support from the Safe Online Initiative and in collaboration with ECPAT International and INTERPOL. UNICEF Innocenti completed surveys with children and caregivers and in-depth interviews with young survivors of online sexual abuse and duty-bearers working in the national child protection systems.

- Launch of the results of a three-year study on digital technology, play and child well-being, produced as part of the RITEC project. The project was co-founded by the LEGO Group and UNICEF and funded by the LEGO Foundation.

- Collaboration with the Dubai Future Foundation to launch the SOWC 2024 report at the Dubai Future Forum 2024. The forum launched SOWC 2024 with UNICEF Youth Foresight Fellows and featured an exhibit as part of the 2050 Future Child project at the Museum of the Future in Dubai in collaboration with Artefact Group.

- Launch of a global research agenda for the intersections of violence against children and violence against women to guide evidence generation together with WHO and SVRI. UNICEF Innocenti also engaged in the First Global Ministerial Conference on Ending Violence against Children.

- Partnership with the UNICEF EU Representation Office in Brussels for *The State of Children in the European Union 2024* report. The report and accompanying policy briefs relied on UNICEF Innocenti's analysis and existing studies, as well as inputs from UNICEF offices, including the UNICEF Regional Office for Europe and Central Asia and UNICEF National Committees in the EU.

- Collaboration with the AUDA-NEPAD and the Pardee Institute for International Futures on the African Continental Free Trade Agreement contributed to integrating children's perspectives into trade policy discourse.

Figure 3: Top new contributions to UNICEF Innocenti Programmes in 2024

Donor name	Partnership name	Duration
Government of Italy	Regular contribution	2024-2026
Government of United Kingdom (FCDO)	Bridging the Gap from Evidence to Action through Improved Coordination and Capacity Building in Implementation Science for Education	2024-2026
GPE (in partnership with IDRC)	Data Must Speak to Strengthen Capacity and Advance Local Evidence Use	2024-2027
GPE (in partnership with IDRC)	Women in Learning Leadership: Advancing Gender-Responsive Education using Evidence	2024-2027
UNICEF Switzerland and Liechtenstein (Jacobs Foundation)	Data Must Speak - Evidence Translation in Ghanaian Schools	2024-2026
US Fund for UNICEF (Google LLC)	Balancing rights in the digital age: Child best interest principles	2024-2025
UN Joint Programme (in partnership with UNICEF Programme Group)	UNFPA-UNICEF Global Programme to Accelerate Action to End Child Marriage	2015-2030
Swedish Committee for UNICEF (Akelius Foundation)	Documentation of the Lessons Learned from the Akelius Digital Language Initiative	2024-2025
US Fund for UNICEF (OpenAI)	Accessible Digital Textbook Initiative	2024-2026
US Fund for UNICEF	Youth Foresight Fellows	2024-2025
UK Committee for UNICEF (Eleva Foundation)	Global Accessible Digital Learning	2024-2026
FCDO (in partnership with UNICEF Programme Group)	Gender Responsive Social Protection Research Uptake	2024-2026
ILO (in partnership with UNICEF Programme Group)	Ending Child Labour in Supply Chains	2023-2026

Annex 1: UNICEF Innocenti partners

1	ABidan Development Consulting Group
2	Action Research for Co-Development (ARCO)
3	African Economic Research Consortium
4	African Union Development Agency-NEPAD
5	Aga Khan Foundation
6	Alana Institute
7	Alma Economics
8	Akelius Foundation
9	Atlantic Council
10	Barça Foundation
11	Blavatnik School of Government, University of Oxford
12	BookFusion
13	Bureau d'Etudes, Nahaza
14	Centre de Recherches et d'Etudes Sociales (CRES), Tunisia
15	Center for Injury Prevention and Research, Bangladesh (CIPRB)
16	Children's Environmental Rights Initiative (CERI)
17	Commission Nationale de l'informatique et des libertés (CNIL)
18	DiploFoundation
19	Dubai Future Foundation
20	Digital Futures Lab
21	Economic Research Group (ERG)
22	ECPAT International
23	EDI Global
24	Eleva Foundation
25	Equimundo – Center for Masculinities and Social Justice
26	European University Institute, Italy
27	Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office (FCDO), the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland
28	Federal Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development (BMZ), Germany
29	Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)
30	Gender at the Centre Initiative
31	Georgetown University – Institute for the Study of International Migration
32	Global Metrics, Bulgaria
33	Global Partnership for Education (GPE)
34	Global School Leaders
35	Government of Finland
36	Government of Italy
37	Groupement d'Intérêts Scientifiques des Statisticiens Economistes (GISSE), Mali

38	Harvard Undergraduate Global Research and Consulting Group
39	Health Media Lab (HML)
40	Hewlett Foundation
41	HML Institute Review Board – Ethics Review Board
42	Institut de Sondage et de Traitement de l'Information Statistique (ISTIS), Tunisia
43	Institut Supérieur des Sciences de la Population (ISSP), Burkina Faso
44	Institute of Development Studies (IDS), University of Sussex
45	Institute of Statistical, Social and Economic Research (ISSER), Ghana
46	International Centre for Climate Change and Development (ICCCAD)
47	International Criminal Police Organization (INTERPOL)
48	International Development Research Centre (IDRC), Canada (Knowledge and Innovation Exchange)
49	International Institute for Educational Planning (IIEP-UNESCO), Dakar
50	International Labour Organization (ILO)
51	International Organization for Migration (IOM)
52	Ivo Pilar Institute, Croatia
53	Jacobs Foundation
54	LEGO Foundation
55	LEGO Group
56	London Metropolitan University
57	London School of Economics and Political Science
58	London School of Hygiene & Tropical Medicine
59	Loss and Damage Youth Coalition (LDYC)
60	Mamidipudi Venkatarangaiya Foundation (MVF)
61	Mundi Consulting
62	MyData Global
63	Instituto Nacional de Estatísticas (INE), Angola
64	Institut National de Statistique (INS), the Democratic Republic of the Congo
65	Institut National de la Statistique (INSTAT), Mali
66	OpenAI
67	Parenting for Lifelong Health (PLH)
68	Paradigm initiative
69	Pedagogical University of Maputo
70	Plan-Eval, the Democratic Republic of the Congo
71	Plan International
72	Population Council, India
73	Prevention Collaborative
74	Public University of Cape Verde
75	Quantumrun
76	Safe Online
77	Save the Children International
78	Schools2030

79	Sexual Violence Research Initiative (SVRI)
80	SMERU Research Institute, Indonesia
81	La Société de Développement International (SDI)
82	South Africa Centre for Evidence (SACE)
83	Southern Cross University – Centre for Children and Young People
84	Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency (Sida)
85	Tech Legality
86	The Frederick S. Pardee Center for International Futures
87	The Finnish Innovation Fund Sitra
88	The GovLab, New York University
89	The Learning for Well-Being Institute, the Netherlands
90	Wittgenstein Centre for Demography and Global Human Capital, Austria
91	United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)
92	United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)
93	United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR)
94	United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA)
95	United Nations University-Center for Policy Research (UNU-CPR)
96	United Nations Women
97	United States Department of Labor
98	University at Buffalo
99	University of North Carolina
100	University of Virginia
101	Western Sydney University
102	World Bank
103	World Bank-UNHCR Joint Data Center
104	World Economic Forum
105	World Health Organization
106	World Vision International
107	Young Lives

Annex 2: Publications

Link to the 2024 publications: https://www.unicef.org/innocenti/reports/view-all?f%5B0%5D=year_in_page_search%3A2024#in-page-search

About us

UNICEF works in the world's toughest places to reach the most disadvantaged children and adolescents — and to protect the rights of every child, everywhere. Across 190 countries and territories, we do whatever it takes to help children survive, thrive and fulfill their potential, from early childhood through adolescence. And we never give up.

UNICEF Innocenti – Global Office of Research and Foresight tackles the questions of greatest importance for children, both current and emerging. It drives change through research and foresight on a wide range of child rights issues, sparking global discourse and actively engaging young people in its work.

UNICEF Innocenti equips thought leaders and decision-makers with the evidence they need to build a better, safer world for children. The office undertakes research on unresolved and emerging issues, using primary and secondary data that represent the voices of children and families themselves. It uses foresight to set the agenda for children, including horizon scanning, trends analysis and scenario development. The office produces a diverse and dynamic library of high-level reports, analyses and policy papers, and provides a platform for debate and advocacy on a wide range of child rights issues.

UNICEF Innocenti provides, for every child, answers to their most pressing concerns.

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